

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Culture as power, technique and labour

SULTANATE CULTURE

- > POWER: conquest, patronage, legitimacy and memory
- > TECHNIQUE: trabeate + arcuate + mortar + dome transition
- > LABOUR: masons, stonecutters, designers and material supply
- > EXPRESSION: monuments, language, literature, music and institutions

VERDICT: architecture is the main archive, not the whole cultural field.

MUST REMEMBER: Trabeate and arcuate techniques interacted through adaptation, reuse, experimentation and dynastic patronage.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Trabeate and arcuate load paths

TRABEATE -> posts support a horizontal lintel or beam

CORBELLED -> courses project inward until the gap is capped

TRUE ARCH -> radiating voussoirs carry compression around an opening

VAULT -> extended arch | DOME -> curved roof over a space

SQUINCH -> corner transition from square chamber toward dome zone

RULE: Sultanate expansion of arcuate practice was not first invention.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Rupture, reuse and adaptation

QUWWAT-UL-ISLAM -> reused pillars + new ritual and political programme

ARHAI DIN KA JHONPRA -> early conversion/adaptation and new facade

SPOLIA -> evidence of appropriation and material reuse

WORKSHOP -> local carving and construction choices remain visible

LIMIT -> one documented complex cannot prove a universal policy

SAFE FORMULA -> rupture + adaptation + technical synthesis.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Qutb complex as layered patronage

AIBAK -> begins mosque/minar programme

ILTUTMISH -> major minar completion + tomb + complex expansion

ALAUDDIN KHALJI -> Alai Darwaza + madrasa + unfinished Alai Minar

FIROZ SHAH TUGHLAQ -> repairs damaged upper minar work

UNESCO / ASI -> present conservation, authenticity and reversible repair

LESSON: read the ensemble across patrons, functions and interventions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Balban to Alai technical sequence

ILTUTMISH TOMB -> square-to-dome transition experiment

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BALBAN TOMB -> first surviving true arch in the assigned source

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ALAI DARWAZA -> mature radiating voussoirs, dome and proportion

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KHALJI URBAN AMBITION -> Siri and the incomplete Alai programme

TRAP: mature mastery is not the same claim as first surviving example.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Tughlaq form and inference discipline

TUGHLAQABAD / GHIYASUDDIN TOMB

- > battered walls + rubble/lime surfaces + massive enclosure
- > fortress effect, strong skyline and restrained ornament
- > arches continue beside lintel-and-beam combinations

OBSERVE form first; qualify claims about economy or insecurity

RULE: austerity is a visual tendency, not proof of one motive.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Regional adaptation matrix

BENGAL -> brick + curved roof / drop-arch associations

GUJARAT -> fine stone carving + local Jain-associated craft vocabulary

MALWA / MANDU -> mass + ventilation + water and climate response

JAUNPUR -> lofty portal or screen + no-minar tendency

COMMON -> shared repertoire adapted to material, labour and court setting

TRAP: regional schools are not imperfect copies of Delhi.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Ornament and visual grammar

CALLIGRAPHY -> script becomes visual through scale and placement

ARABESQUE -> geometric-vegetal pattern joined to inscription

LOCAL MOTIFS -> lotus, bell and swastika in adapted workshop vocabularies

COLOUR / MATERIAL -> sandstone, marble and surface contrast

RELIGIOUS SPACE -> often non-figural, but avoid an absolute for all contexts

USE: surface grammar supports synthesis only when tied to a monument.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Building types and social functions

MOSQUE -> congregation, ritual orientation and community visibility

MINAR -> elevated landmark and call-to-prayer association

TOMB -> burial memory, patronage and skyline

MADRASA -> learning and learned patronage

KHANQAH -> Sufi discipline, teaching, hospitality and community

FORT / CITY -> defence, residence, supply, water and political theatre.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Language, literature and music

PERSIAN -> court, administration, diplomacy and chronicles

SANSKRIT -> continuing scholarship and textual production

REGIONAL LANGUAGES -> expanding literary and social expression

AMIR KHUSRAU -> Persianate-Hindavi literary evidence and linguistic plurality

MUSIC -> court, devotional and regional contact

CAUTION: do not credit Khusrau with every later instrument or form.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Qutb complex, Alai Darwaza and Tughlaqabad must be read through feature, phase and political context.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence and conservation ladder

MONUMENT FORM -> structure and spatial organisation | motive may be uncertain

INSCRIPTION -> patron, act, date or formula | selective public claim

CHRONICLE -> patronage and elite vocabulary | genre and court bias

LEGEND -> later memory | needs independent dating and corroboration

UNESCO / ASI -> current integrity and repair | not medieval provenance

METHOD -> claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> explicit qualification.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Spolia or stylistic borrowing cannot by itself establish one motive, community relation or linear architectural rupture.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 11 answer spine

OPEN -> cultural field shaped by power, technique, labour and adaptation

TECHNIQUE -> trabeate/arcuate, true arch, dome transition and mortar

SEQUENCE -> reuse -> Qutb/Iltutmish -> Balban -> Khalji -> Tughlaq

REGION -> Bengal, Gujarat, Malwa and Jaunpur transform the repertoire

CULTURE -> institutions + ornament + multilingual literary worlds

CLOSE -> new plural idioms emerged without erasing rupture or hierarchy.